

Staple food prices continue to increase following removal of wheat subsidies

Key Messages

- Most areas of Sudan are expected to continue facing Minimal (IPC Phase 1) or Stressed (IPC Phase 2) acute food insecurity through September 2018. However, most IDPs in SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan, IDPs in Jebel Marra in Darfur, and poor households in parts of Kassala and North Darfur affected by below-average 2017 rains are likely to continue to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) through May 2018 due to displacement, poor production or limited agricultural opportunities, and/or very high staple food prices. Food security among IDPs in SPLM-N areas of South Kordofan is likely to deteriorate from Crisis (IPC Phase 3) to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) between June and September 2018.
- Despite the above-average 2017/18 harvest, staple food prices continued to increase during February 2018 following the removal of wheat subsidies and the devaluation of the Sudanese Pound in early 2018. Retail millet and sorghum prices increased by 20 to 30 percent between January and February on most markets. On average, current levels of retail staple food prices (sorghum, millet, and wheat) are two to three times higher than last year's levels and the recent four-year average.
- The Strategic Reserve Corporation (SRC) of the Agricultural Bank of Sudan (ABS) is attempting to control staple food prices and improve market access through prepositioning and selling subsidized sorghum in areas affected by dryness during the 2017/18 season. As of mid-March, the SRC has prepositioned 160,151 MT of sorghum in dryness-affected, including 11,430 MT in Kassala and 10,930 MT in North Darfur state.
- Over 4,500 South Sudanese refugees arrived in Sudan in February, increasing the number of new arrivals in 2018 to over 10,300 refugees, which is significantly less than the number who arrived at this time by this time in 2017. The total number of South Sudanese refugees arrived in Sudan since mid-2013 is estimated to be more than 771,367.

* FEWS NET classification is **IPC**-compatible with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).